



Vast experience: Stuart Law has previously served as head coach for Bangladesh and West Indies, and as interim coach for Sri Lanka and Afghanistan. He also coached the Bangladesh Under-19s and led Bangladesh to its first Asia Cup final in 2012.^{AFP}

Canada, which is, you know, their first game, and what a first game to start with. The oldest history of international cricket matches is in the USA and Canada. Who'd have thought? So, yeah, whether we have the home-ground advantage, I don't know. Yes. Some of our boys have played in Major League Cricket in Dallas. They also played Minor League Cricket in Dallas. It's tough because we haven't played in New York. No one's played on the ground in New York. So I wouldn't say we've got the out-and-out home-ground advantage, but what we do have is the excitement of playing in different venues in the USA. And if we do get that support from the home crowd, it'll be awesome. I just hope that everyone loves the underdog like we do in Australia.

As the head coach, what are your main priorities and goals leading up to the T20 World Cup?

My main goal was to get to know and understand the players and staff around me and build relationships with them. Good relationships can create really good environments. So that's been the number one thing. It's been a little bit disjointed because we were in camp together, and then we had a week's break. Then we came back, and we played the series against Canada. I felt we started building good momentum together and enjoying what we were doing. And then we had a bit of time away. My goal is simple: I want to see our team approach every game with a smile, embracing the joy of playing the sport we love. Beyond that, I expect us to compete fiercely at every opportunity, striving for excellence on all fronts. It doesn't matter if we win or lose. I just want to see the competitiveness. And if we get some of the boys with a real competitive spirit firing on the day, then wins will come. It's all about progressing through the next phase. That'd be a dream come true. I think we've got to be realistic in our expectations as well and make sure that we maintain those expectations throughout the whole process. But number one, just build relationships and enjoy each other's company. World Cups are very special to play, and they don't come around very often. Fingers

crossed, we can get out there and give a good account of ourselves.

Obviously, in the Canada series, the USA did remarkably well, blanking the Canadians. With the Bangladesh series coming up, it will be a good litmus test for the USA team because now you're playing against a team that is known to surprise many people in the previous World Cups.

Yeah, it is a great challenge for us. That's for sure. Bangladesh has come on leaps and bounds in the last couple of years. They've got a very good pace bowling attack now. Everyone knows they're renowned for their spin bowling, but they now have a good pace bowling attack. And their batsmen have always been productive. So what a great challenge for us. We have four matches, three in Houston down at Prairie View, and then we come to Dallas and play a warm-up game against them at Grand Prairie. We'll get an idea of what we're up against, and they're a pretty good benchmark to see where we're actually at. So, I think all the boys are excited about playing against Bangladesh. I'm always excited to play international cricket, but against some of the boys I coached many years ago, it should be nice catching up with them. It would